

Proposals

Proposals

- Put forth action plans
- Invitation to participate
- Collaboration with non-researchers

Feasibility Test

- Prove that the solution is capable and suitable
- The solution will have its intended effects and fit the situation that it is in
- Make an issue-problem-solution table

Example:

- Project 2--> Brookline Bird Club
- Project 3--> How should the declining number of wild bird species be addressed?
- Project 4--> Proposal to implement a solution

Issue-Problem-Solution Table

Issue	Cats are killing wild birds		
Problems	Cats are overbreeding	Cats are allowed to roam freely	Birds are not protected
Solutions	Implement free spade and neuter clinics	Pass laws that require cats to be on a leash	Create a sanctuary

Analyze Suitability (should it be done) and Capability (can it be done) of each solution

Solution	Spade and Neuter Clinics	Leash Law	Bird Sanctuary
Suitability	Will reduce number of cats	How will it be enforced, for instance in someone's backyard	Only Protects bird in one space
Capability	High cost, need to convince pet owners	Will need to convince politicians	Need to purchase land and hire people to maintain it

Types of Proposals

- **Proposal for Funding** --> the problem is a lack of money (participation: give me money)
 - Description of project--> What it is?
 - Rationale---> Why do it?
 - Outcomes---> What do you hope will happen?
 - Logistics---> How will that happen?
 - Timeline---> When will that happen?
 - Credentials---> On whose authority will it happen?
 - Budget---> How much will it cost?
- Ex: "Poets of Place (POP!)" by Sarah Ehrich and Meredith Jordan

Types of Proposals

- **Proposal for More Research**
- Consider your implications sections:
 - Evaluate--> propose to research where you were limited
 - Suggest an Approach---> Propose to Research the approach you suggested
 - Speculate--> Propose to research what would happen in the future
 - Reach out--> Propose to research how an adjacent group would be affected
 - Typically involves asking an authority permission to implement a plan
 - Need to outline a methodology (how would this research be conducted?)
 - E.g. observations, surveys, case studies, etc
- Format: Background, objectives, methodology
- EX: "Training Fighters, Making Men: A Study of Amateur Boxers and Trainer" by Stacy Yi

Types of Proposals

- **Petitions**

- Ask for participation through signing your name (low stakes)
- Creates a shared sense of identity--> when you sign you are part of the group
 - e.g. “we are all in this fight together”
- Generates an emotional appeal
- EX: "Tell Apple: Stop Slavery Practices at Foxconn's Manufactories" by Monica Balmelli

Proposal Basic Outline

- 1) State the problem
- 2) Describe the solution
- 3) Explain the reasons
- 4) Ending--> reinforce main point/ call to action

Ethical considerations to make

- All proposals are built around identifying a problem and solution
- This creates an ethical binary of “right” and “wrong”
- As a researcher, you are taking a side (albeit a thoroughly researched side)
- Important to recognize your own assumptions when advancing a proposal